EP 1

1 **INT. DYLAN'S BEDROOM - DAY** 1

ELSA LOCKHART (20, innocent beauty with mischievous eyes) tiptoes into Dylan's bedroom. She spots a framed photograph on the dresser - her and Dylan when she was 19. She quickly opens the drawer and buries it beneath his clothes.

The sound of running water catches her attention. She turns toward the bathroom door, left slightly ajar.

Through the steamy glass shower door, DYLAN LANCASTER (36, ruggedly handsome) is showering. Elsa's eyes widen as the water cascades down his muscular frame.

ELSA'S FANTASY BEGINS:

The steam parts as if inviting her. Elsa moves toward the shower in a trance. Her fingertips touch the glass.

Dylan turns, noticing her. Instead of surprise, his eyes darken with desire. He slides the shower door open.

Elsa steps forward, fully clothed. The water soaks through her thin blouse, revealing her curves. Dylan pulls her against his wet, naked body.

His one hand brushes through her body, the other slowly gripping her neck with just the right amount of force. His grip slides down to her thigh as as he presses her against the shower wall. Dylan teases her; he kisses her a sweet second, only to make her want him more. She gasps as he leaves her hanging. As his hand slides between her thighs,

DYLAN (O.S.)
(harsh, real)
Elsa! What are you doing in my room?

FANTASY ENDS

Dylan stands by the shower, with a towel wrapped around his waist, droplets of water still clinging to his chest. His expression is stern, disapproving.

ELSA
(flustered)
Sorry! I was just... looking for my sweater. Thought it might've gotten mixed in with your laundry.

DYLAN
(notices the missing photo)
Where did our camping trip photo go?

ELSA
That ancient thing? Don't you think it's time for some updated memories?

She moves toward the door, but Dylan blocks her path.

DYLAN
(authoritative)
Hold it right there, young lady.

Dylan gestures with his eyes at her extremely short skirt. Elsa catches it and sighs, frustrated at Dylan playing conservative dad.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
I can literally SEE your underwear.

ELSA
It's LITERALLY what every girl wears on campus.

DYLAN
I don't give a damn what "every girl" wears. I promised your parents I'd take care of you, and that's exactly what I'm going to do.

ELSA
(suddenly tense, angry)
Don't bring them up!!! Ever!

DYLAN
(softens slightly)
Elsa, I didn't mean to upset you.

ELSA
(crossing her arms, sassy)
Whatever. We are not even blood-related. Plus, in case you forgot, in 20 days, I turn 21. I'll be a grown-up.

DYLAN
A grown-up? Young lady, you've been sneaking around lately. What are you up to, Elsa?

ELSA
(with a flirtatious smile)
Spoiler: You won't have to wait long.

She slips past him, leaving Dylan troubled.

2 **INT. UNIVERSITY CLASSROOM - DAY** 2

Dylan, dressed in a tailored suit, strides into the lecture hall. Female students swoon and whisper as he passes. He remains stoic, professional.

DYLAN
Today, we'll be analyzing the psychological underpinnings of Dostoevsky's Crime and Punishment, specifically focusing on...

The door opens. All heads turn.

ELSA walks in confidently, wearing a form-fitting outfit. She locks eyes with Dylan and smiles sweetly.

ELSA
Sorry I'm late, Professor. I'm the new transfer student.

Dylan is frozen in shock.

EP 2

3 **INT. UNIVERSITY CLASSROOM - DAY** 3

ELSA
Sorry I'm late, Professor. I'm the new transfer student.

Dylan freezes, his professional demeanor cracking. He tugs at his collar, clears his throat, and forces himself back into professor mode.

DYLAN
(tersely)
Take a seat. We've already started.

Elsa smirks, satisfied. She strides toward an empty desk. The BOYS in class whispers and WOWs at her charm.

Across the room, three perfectly polished students — ANNA, MONICA, and LAURA (all early 20s, Instagram-ready) — glare daggers at Elsa. They huddle together, whispering.

ANNA
(hushed, venomous)
Who does she think she is?

MONICA
Innocent new girl act? Please.

LAURA
No one flirts with OUR professor and gets away with it.

As Elsa passes Anna's desk, Anna’s hand flicks. A blade slices Elsa’s bag. Her books and pens spill across the floor with a loud CLATTER.

Dylan turns from the whiteboard, eyebrow raised.

ELSA
(embarrassed)
Oops! Sorry I-

She scrambles to collect her belongings. Spotting an empty seat, she hurries over and sits down - not noticing the clear adhesive Monica applied moments earlier.

RIIIIIP! Her skirt tears loudly as she stands back up in shock.

ELSA (CONT'D)
(yelps in pain)
Ah!

DYLAN
Is there a problem, Miss Lockhart?

ELSA
(holding torn skirt discreetly)
Nope! Not at all.

The trio exchange smug looks. Dylan returns to his lecture. Elsa sits miserably, trying to hold her skirt together.

Later, as class winds down:

DYLAN
Before we wrap up, it's department policy that new transfer students give a brief self-introduction. Miss Lockhart, are you prepared?

ELSA
(brightening)
Yes, absolutely!

While Elsa organizes her notes, Anna deftly swipes Elsa's flash drive from her open bag. Monica slides a replacement into the pile of Elsa's scattered belongings.

Elsa grabs the drive, heads to the front, and plugs it into the computer. She clicks play, then turns to face the class confidently.

MOANING sounds fill the room. Elsa spins around to see explicit pornographic images projected on the massive screen behind her. Her face goes white.

Students GASP. Some snicker. Others look away, embarrassed.

DYLAN
(cold fury)
ENOUGH!

He slams the laptop shut. The classroom falls silent.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Miss Lockhart. My office. Now!

The mean girl trio celebrates with a synced victory hair flip.

EP 3

4 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY** 4

Dylan SLAMS into his office, the door banging against the wall. Elsa jumps. He locks the door behind him with a decisive CLICK.

He advances on her, towering and intimidating. Elsa backs up until she hits the wall. Dylan plants his hands on either side of her head, caging her in.

DYLAN
(voice dangerously low)
Transferring to my department without telling me? And what’s up with that video?

ELSA
I don’t know why that video is on my flash drive...maybe I grabbed the wrong one...

DYLAN
(leaning closer)
You're saying you do have porns stash somewhere? Since when? What else have you been hiding from me?

ELSA
(suddenly defiant)
What's your problem?
(MORE)

ELSA (CONT'D)
I'm twenty years old! It's perfectly legal for me to watch whatever I want!

Dylan steps back, visibly thrown off balance, his expression shifts. He turns away, running a hand through his hair.

DYLAN
Jesus Christ, Elsa.

Elsa quickly slides up behind him and hug him, pressing her cheek against his back.

ELSA
(softly)
Why does it bother you so much, Uncle Dylan?

Dylan's breathing changes. He goes rigid but doesn't pull away. We can see the conflict playing across his face.

DYLAN
(strained)
Let go. Now.

ELSA
(tightening her grip)
No.

DYLAN
(more firmly)
This is inappropriate. Let go.

ELSA
(voice cracking)
Why? You used to hold me all the time! What changed?

Dylan's hand hovers over her arms wrapped around his waist, trembling slightly. For a moment, it looks like he might caress her hand, give in to the touch.

ELSA (CONT'D)
I've made the same wish last year. Do you remember? I said I want to be...

DYLAN
(closing his eyes, pained)
"Uncle Dylan's bride when I grow up."

He abruptly breaks free from her embrace. They both stand there, breathing heavily, faces flushed.

ELSA
I've grown up now!

DYLAN
(avoiding her gaze)
No, Elsa. It's not going to happen. That’s not allowed.

ELSA
(vulnerable)
Why not?

Dylan finally meets her eyes. The tension between them is electric.

EP 4

5 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY** 5

Dylan sighs, grips Elsa's shoulders, locking eyes with her.

DYLAN
Elsa, we talked about this. I'm way older than you! And now, I'm even your professor...

ELSA
That's not a reason. That wouldn’t matter if you had loved me! You don’t love me!

DYLAN
(avoiding her)
Of course I love you...

Elsa looks up, as if she sees some hope. But Dylan continues.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
As family, as I promised my best friend, your father, before he died. to always protect you and love you-

Elsa's expression shifts from hurt to anger. She tries to break free from Dylan’s grip.

ELSA
If that's what you truly believe... fine. Keep telling yourself that.

She angrily pushes Dylan away, her hand accidentally hitting a framed picture on the wall. The frame falls toward her. Elsa turns, sees it, and screams.

ELSA (CONT'D)
Ah!

SLOW MOTION:

Dylan pulls Elsa into a protective embrace. The frame crashes against his back. He winces in pain but doesn't loosen his grip on her.

Time seems to freeze for Elsa. All she can see is Dylan's face inches from hers, feeling his warm breath. They're close enough to kiss...

Dylan and Elsa remain locked in their embrace, both breathing heavily. It takes a while for both of them to realize what actually happened. Elsa's anger melts into concern as she tries to push his suit aside.

ELSA (CONT'D)
Are you okay? Let me see!

Watching her panic, Dylan can't help but smile, affectionately tousling her hair.

DYLAN
Remember your favorite story when you were little? The one with monsters invading the kingdom, where only knights could protect the princess? You'd badger me constantly, "Uncle Dylan, will you be my knight?"

They steady each other as they stand up straight.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Princess's knight —that's where I belong.

Elsa stares at his injured shoulder, her lips parting to speak, but she swallows her words. Instead, she tenderly adjusts his clothes, her eyes betraying her concern.

Just then, Anna, Monica, and Laura pass by the doorway. Through the gap, they spot Elsa intimately fixing Dylan's clothes. They exchange glances, suspicion written across their faces.

6 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY** 6

Elsa walks down the hallway, looking around with curiosity until,

THUMP!

Someone pushes her from behind. Elsa falls immediately on her knees. It’s Anna, Monica, and Laura. They come around and surround Elsa.

Elsa looks up in shock.

EP 5

7 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 7

Anna stands over Elsa, her hand still raised from the push.

ANNA
(shouting)
Look who it is! Transfer trash, hooking up with Professor Lancaster!

Their voices are carrying across the courtyard.

MONICA
The whole school knows now.

LAURA
Such a desperate whore!

Students stop and stare. Whispers ripple through the crowd. Elsa adjusts herself, confused.

ELSA
What are you talking about?

ANNA
Pretend to be innocent. Of course. But I got it all recorded.

Anna holds up her phone. On the screen: a video of Elsa and Dylan in an emotional embrace from earlier.

Elsa's face goes pale.

ELSA
That's... not what it looks like—

MONICA
Don’t bother explain, SLUT!

LAURA
Pathetic. Can’t even pass a class without turning office hours into after hours.

Their words catch on like wildfire —more voices from the crowd joined in, spitting insults. Someone hurl trash at her.

VERONICA FISHER (32, stunning, sophisticated and radiating authority) approaches through the crowd. Anna, Monica and Laura phony stops, with kiss-up smiles on their faces.

ANNA
Professor Fisher! We didn't know you are around...

ELSA
(glimpse hope)
P...Professor! Help! These students are trying to insult and bully me!

Veronica looks around at the situation.

VERONICA
(cold)
True. Students who cross boundaries need to learn their place.

Elsa finally relaxes and lets out a deep breath.

Suddenly, Veronica walks up to her, stepping on her hand with her high heel.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
(cruel whisper)
I mean YOU.

Elsa's eyes widen, screams. She can't believe what's happening.

EP 6

8 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 8

Veronica lifts her heel off Elsa's hand, enjoying her pain.

VERONICA
(fake innocent)
Oops. Slipped.

Anna, Monica, and Laura laughs out.

MONICA
Not your fault, professor. They should clean up the trash.

LAURA
This piece of trash tried to seduce YOUR Professor Lancaster on her first day! She deserves more.

ANNA
(with sweet smile)
Everyone knows you and Professor Lancaster are perfect together!

ELSA
(in shock)
What? No, Dylan will never date...

But they won’t let her finish. Three mean girls kick her with knee, snatch her bag, and pull her hair.

ELSA (CONT'D)
Ah! Stop!

Elsa hurts all over and can’t lift her head.

ELSA (CONT'D)
How dare you!!! I’m reporting this to the principal!

VERONICA
(laugh)
Oh yes, we should.

Suddenly, Principal Robertson appears around the corner, approaching the group.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON (O.S.)
What’s the chaos here?

ELSA
Principal Robertson! Please! Help!

Veronica immediately drops to the floor, clutching her arm dramatically.

Principal Robertson sees this and immediately gets furious.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
What is this? Explain!

EP 7

9 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 9

VERONICA
(fake tears)
Principal! This student just attacked me! She's crazy!

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
What! How dare you!

ELSA
(helpless)
I...I...didn’t...

10 **INT. CAMPUS - DAY** 10

Meanwhile, Dylan frantically dials Elsa's number. It goes straight to voicemail.

DYLAN
Come on, Elsa. Pick up...

STUDENTS (O.S.)
Did you hear that the newbie blew up the hallway?

DYLAN
Damn!

He runs away.

11 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY** 11

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
(to Elsa)
Assaulting faculty? Inappropriate behavior with professors? Call your parents immediately!

VERONICA
She doesn't have parents. That's probably why she acts like this. Let me discipline her. I know how to deal with troubled girls.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
(nodding)
Your family's contribution to this school is invaluable. Whatever you think is best.

The Principal leaves. It’s just Veronica and the trio. Elsa backs against the wall, fear in her eyes as Veronica signals to Anna, Monica, and Laura.

VERONICA
(to the girls)
Time to teach her some respect. Rip off her clothes!

The three girls advance menacingly toward Elsa.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
(pulling out her phone)
Let’s livestream this so the whole school can see how this filthy whore throws herself around in public!

They start to take off her jewelry, rip off her clothes. Elsa fights back but is helpless.

ELSA
Let me go! You bitches! Let me go!

Just then, Dylan rushes over and stands in front of Elsa.

DYLAN
STOP!

Elsa looks at him with tear-filled, desperate eyes.

EP 8

12 **INT. HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS** 12

Great pain is seen in Dylan’s eyes. But he tries to keep calm in front of others.

Veronica looks at Dylan with mock concern.

VERONICA
Protecting a student who's been seducing you? Not very professional, Dylan.

Dylan stops. He can only watch Elsa on the ground, but force his expression into cold professionalism.

DYLAN
Handling a situation like this here is not very professional either.

Veronica links her arm through his possessively.

VERONICA
(sweet)
You're absolutely right. Let's discuss this privately.

Elsa stares at Dylan in disbelief.

ELSA
Are you agreeing with her? You think I should be expelled too?

DYLAN
(cold mask)
You go home. Now.

Elsa's face crumbles. She turns and walks away, shoulders shaking.

13 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY** 13

Dylan looks at Veronica anxiously, while she wears nothing but a proud, smug smile.

DYLAN
That video was a misunderstanding. Don't expel Elsa. Hold me accountable.

VERONICA
(sarcastic)
Awww. Very touching.

DYLAN
(tries to be patient)
Veronica. Please.

Veronica tilted her head back, leaning closer to Dylan. She trails her fingers along his shoulder seductively.

VERONICA
(circling him aggressively)
You know, her future is fully in your hands.

EP 9

14 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 14

Veronica’s fingers continues to savor him, under pressure.

VERONICA
Date me. Out loud. In front of everyone. Then, your little girl stays. No? Then, she disappears. Poof.

She presses him closer, smiles.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
You know we are meant to be, right?

DYLAN
(reluctant)
Veronica, this isn't right.

VERONICA
(cutting him off)
Oh really? Fine. She's gone.

Dylan closes his eyes in defeat.

DYLAN
What the hell do you want from me...

15 **EXT. UNIVERSITY GATES - DAY** 15

Elsa clutches her books and supplies, tears streaming down her face. She looks back at the beautiful campus.

ELSA (V.O.)
Sorry Mom and Dad. I failed you.

Principal Robertson approaches her.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
Miss Lockhart.

Elsa raises her head in shock.

ELSA
Principal!

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
Well, your expulsion has been reversed. You're reinstated. But, you better behave yourself.

Elsa wipes her tears, face lighting up.

ELSA
Really?! Thank you so much!

As Principal Robertson leaves, she looks at campus in joy.

ELSA (V.O.)
It has to be Dylan! He saved me!
I'm gonna find him and say thanks.

Just then, Dylan and Veronica appear at the gate- his jacket on her shoulder, their arms crossed.

Seeing Elsa in the distance, Veronica pulls Dylan close and straightens his tie with deliberate intimacy.

From Elsa's POV, they are kissing; her eyes burn in jealousy.

Dylan keeps his eyes forward, nodding at Veronica's jokes. Veronica stares at Elsa with a triumphant smile. They slip into a luxury car, laughter echoing as it pulls away.

Elsa stands alone, her brief joy completely destroyed.

EP 10

16 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT** 16

The living room is lit only by a small lamp. Elsa sits curled on the couch. The clock shows 11:42 PM.

Dylan enters, slightly disheveled, his movements careful but unsteady. He reeks faintly of wine.

ELSA
(coldly)
Had fun?

DYLAN
Your expulsion's been overturned.
Go to bed. You've got class.

ELSA
Where were you? With her?

DYLAN
That's nothing something a little girl should be asking a far older adult.

ELSA
(hurt)
A little girl ? Is that all I am to you?

DYLAN
(firmly)
That's what you're supposed to be.

Elsa steps closer, her voice breaking.

ELSA
So you can get all cozy with that evil woman, but when I need you—

DYLAN
(cutting her off)
Elsa, don’t... you know it’s completely different...

ELSA
What do I know? I’m just A LITTLE GIRL!

Elsa turns away sharply, her hand accidentally striking his injured shoulder. Dylan winces, a sharp intake of breath. Elsa's anger dissolves instantly. She turns back, horrified.

ELSA (CONT'D)
God, I'm sorry. I didn't mean to...

She rushes to him, carefully examining his shoulder.

ELSA (CONT'D)
Let me see. Is it getting worse?

DYLAN
It’s alright-

They almost speak at the same time and their faces are inches apart as she tries to inspect the wound.

But Elsa gets tripped by a pillow and falls towards Dylan.

SLOW MOTION:

The two fall to the sofa. Their lips accidentally brush.

Both freeze, startled by the contact. Heart pounding.

Dylan looks away.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
You saw it today... It’s dangerous to be with me.

He carefully looks up only to find heartbreak in Elsa’s eyes.

ELSA
I don’t care! Everyone in my family have left me... You promised that you'd always be with me...

With vulnerable eyes, she pulls Dylan a little closer.

ELSA (CONT'D)
Are you gonna leave me too?

Dylan's expression shifts, something breaking behind his eyes. His resolve crumbles.

He caresses her cheek, stares into her teary eyes, then kisses her deeply. As if he would never let her go.

EP 11

17 **INT. DYLAN’S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - CONTINUOUS** 17

Dylan and Elsa collapse into the sofa, mouths locked, embrace getting more intense. Dylan’s hand finds her waist, her body urging him closer. But just as the moment crests, he tears away—eyes clouded with turmoil.

DYLAN
(breathless, fighting his feelings)
Elsa... we can’t...I can’t.

Elsa stares at him looking for the answer, then smiles.

ELSA
It’s okay. I can wait. I’m not going anywhere anyways, right?

Elsa nonchalantly gives the bandages to Dylan and walks away.

MONTAGE:

18 **EXT. CAMPUS - DAY** 18

Elsa walks with classmates. Dylan passes by. She turns, her face lighting up with a happy lively smile.

19 **INT. CLASSROOM - DAY** 19

In class, students hunched over test papers. Elsa carefully slips Dylan a neatly folded note. His expression: torn between duty and desire.

20 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY** 20

Dylan discusses with other professors. Elsa sneaks up, taps his shoulder, then skips away with childlike joy. He turns, watching her go with a mixture of tenderness and torment.

END MONTAGE

21 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - ELSA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 21

Elsa writes in her journal, voice-over as we see her writing with dreamy expression.

ELSA (V.O.)
He keeps pushing me away, but... every glance, every touch says otherwise. Maybe it's complicated... but it's worth holding onto.

22 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY** 22

Elsa perched innocently on the edge of Dylan's desk while he tries to grade papers, visibly distracted by her presence.

DYLAN
(concerned, checking the door)
Elsa, I told you. Not here!

ELSA
Why? I can't come and ask about my assignment?

DYLAN
It assembly. If someone notices you're gone-

He's cutting off. Footsteps approach. A knock at the door.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON (O.S.)
Mr.Lancaster? Do you have a moment?

Dylan and Elsa freeze, panic washing over their faces. Dylan's protective instinct immediately kicks in.

ELSA
(whispers, frightened)
What do we do?

They looks around in panic.

EP 12

23 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - CONTINUOUS** 23

Principal Robertson enters the office. Dylan sits up straight at his desk, posture unusually stiff. Unbeknownst to Principal Robertson, Elsa is hidden beneath Dylan’s desk.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
(energetically)
Dylan, perfect timing! The board just confirmed we'll be hosting the British Literature symposium next month.

Dylan nods, trying to maintain composure as he subtly adjusts his position to better conceal Elsa.

DYLAN
(overly formal)
That's... wonderful news, Principal Robertson. A great opportunity for our students.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
(clueless)
Indeed! We'll need you to prepare a presentation on modern interpretations of Victorian literature. You’re ideal for this.

Under the desk, Elsa mischievously observes Dylan's legs. With playful curiosity, she gently touches the area around his thighs.

Dylan jolts visibly, as if shocked by electricity.

DYLAN
I-I'd be h-happy to... to contribute. Victorian l-literature is... is...

Principal Robertson studies Dylan's face with concern.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
Dylan, you look flushed. Are you feeling alright?

Dylan grips the edge of his desk, forcing a smile while silently fuming. We can imagine what Elsa is doing right now.

DYLAN
(through gritted teeth)
Just a bit warm in here. Nothing to worry about. Please, continue...

Principal Robertson is unconvinced but wraps up regardless.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
I'll email you the details. Take good care of yourself, will you?

The door closes. Dylan immediately pushes back his chair, lifts Elsa from under the desk and places her on top of it, his expression a mixture of frustration and affection. His face is extremely close to Elsa’s.

DYLAN
(stern but gentle)
Do you understand how much trouble we could both be in?

ELSA
(lingeringly)
You said the same thing last time, when we kissed in that empty classroom.

DYLAN
(alert and cuts her off)
I SAID no talking about that. And that was an accident, too.

ELSA
Sure sure.
(excited)
Anyway, it’s my 21st birthday soon! I have something special for you!

Dylan's expression softens, unable to stay upset with her. Before he answers, Veronica appears at the doorway, a smirk spreading across her face as she observes them.

VERONICA
Am I interrupting something?

Dylan and Elsa turn toward her, frozen in place.

EP 13

24 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY** 24

Veronica stares at Elsa in cold smile.

VERONICA
Still trying to seduce your teacher, sweetie?

Dylan ushers Elsa out of the office. Elsa leaves with worry.

DYLAN
She’s been asking about her assignment. That’s all-

VERONICA
(cutting him off)
I'm so disappointed in you, Dylan. Still tangled up with that little child.

She moves closer, her voice turning dangerous.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
Don’t fool yourself — the expulsion isn’t forgotten. And don't think I haven't seen your little tricks on campus.

She pulls out a USB drive, dangling it like a weapon.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
The evidence is still in my hands. Next time, what could it be?

She trails her finger down his chest as she speaks.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
I'll completely destroy her. She's only twenty. You couldn't bear to watch that happen, could you?

DYLAN
(pleading)
Please, don't do this to Elsa.

VERONICA
That depends entirely on your performance, honey.

She leans closer, her breath on his ear.

25 **INT. HALLWAY - CONTINUOUS** 25

Elsa tries to press her ear against the door.

From where she stood, Veronica’s silhouette overlapped perfectly with Dylan’s. Their bodies were far too close, Veronica’s head tilting, exactly like they are kissing.

ELSA (V.O.)
(horrified)
What are they doing...

EP 14

26 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY** 26

Dylan shoves Veronica away with force.

DYLAN
Please.

She staggered but didn’t look the slightest bit upset. Instead, that fatal smile lingered on her lips.

VERONICA
Next time I’ll kiss you for real.

She takes one step back.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
I want you to be absolutely clear with her. No mixed signals, no hope, no room for fantasy.

Her fingers trace his jawline with the USB drive.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
I’m sure you can do that.

DYLAN
(forced, quiet)
Of course.

27 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY** 27

Elsa is holding her breath, still trying to sneak a glance. The door suddenly swings open. Veronica emerges.

She steps closer, smirks. Her eyes deliberately scan Elsa's body, stopping at her chest.

VERONICA
(tugging at Elsa's collar)
Young lady, get real. What kind of man would want... this?

She gestures dismissively at Elsa's flat chest.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
(gestures at herself)
Real women have something to offer.

Elsa's face burns red. Veronica saunters away, leaving Elsa standing there, humiliated and shaking.

28 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - ELSA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 28

Elsa is putting on a short top that accentuates her chest.

ELSA
She's wrong...she's wrong!

She looks into the mirror and adjusts her chest carefully.

ELSA (CONT'D)
I can do it.

29 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT** 29

Dylan sits in the couch. He freezes when he sees Elsa comes downstairs with her short top. His jaw drops.

DYLAN
What the hell are you wearing?

ELSA
Is there a problem?

DYLAN
(stepping toward her)
You're not leaving this house in that. Go change. Now.

ELSA (V.O.)
IT WORKS!

Elsa walks towards him, slowly pressing her body against his.

ELSA
Hmm. Maybe... you're right. This top is so tight, it's cutting off my circulation. Can you help me see if it's too small... right here?

She guides his hand toward her chest. Dylan jerks back, horrified.

DYLAN
Elsa, what are you doing...

Mid-sentence, Elsa's eyes roll back. She collapses.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
ELSA!

EP 15

30 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 30

Dylan cradles Elsa's limp body, panic.

DYLAN
Elsa! Are you ok?

Suddenly, Elsa's arms snake around his neck. Her eyes flutter open, a wicked smile spreading across her lips.

ELSA
(breathless whisper)
Got you.

Dylan's relief instantly transforms to fury.

DYLAN
It wasn't funny.

He tries to push her away, but Elsa's grip tightens around his waist like a vice.

ELSA
(triumphant)
I KNEW it! You care about me!

DYLAN
Nonsense. Let go of me!

Elsa presses closer, her hand flat against his racing heart.

ELSA
(sultry)
No, Dylan. FEEL it...

She traces her finger down his chest. Dylan's breathing hitches despite himself.

ELSA (CONT'D)
That's WANT. You WANT me.

She releases him and skips away like nothing happened, leaving Dylan standing there, shaken.

31 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - ELSA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 31

Elsa stands by a mirror in a fancy dress, excited and nervous.

ELSA (V.O.)
21st birthday! Finally! Tonight changes everything. Tonight, I give him all of me.

She applies a final touch of lipstick. She hears movements from downstairs.

ELSA
Dylan! I'm ready for my birthday surprise!

32 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT** 32

Elsa walks toward the living room joyfully but freezes at the entrance. Her expression shifts from anticipation to horror.

From her perspective: Dylan is bent over on the couch, his head lowered toward Veronica who lies beneath him. Their position suggests intimacy.

Elsa gasps involuntarily. The sound makes Dylan look up. Their eyes meet across the room - his filled with panic, hers with devastation.

EP 16

33 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 33

Elsa stands frozen. Her voice cracks with betrayal.

ELSA
What the hell is this, Dylan? What the fuck are you doing?!

Dylan slowly stands, his face a mask of cold indifference. Veronica remains draped across the couch.

DYLAN
(cruel)
Exactly what it looks like. Veronica is my girlfriend.

ELSA
(voice rising)
You're lying to me! After everything happened —

DYLAN
(cold)
Nothing happened between us, Elsa. Whatever that was was never real.

Elsa staggers backward as if slapped.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
You are just a child. Sorry if you misunderstood.

Elsa's face crumples. Without another word, she turns and BOLTS for the door.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(instinctively stepping forward)
Elsa, wait-

Veronica's manicured hand shoots out, gripping his wrist like a shackle.

VERONICA
(deadly sweet)
Remember our deal, darling. The show must go on, or that girl's academic career dies tomorrow.

She glides to the bar, pouring two glasses of wine with theatrical elegance.

Dylan stares at the door Elsa fled through, his jaw working. Veronica presses a wine glass into his trembling hand.

34 **EXT. PARK - NIGHT** 34

Elsa collapses on a bench, gasping for air. Her perfect birthday dress is wrinkled, her makeup streaked with tears.

ELSA
(sobbing to herself)
How could I be so stupid? So fucking STUPID! Fucking childish!

She doubles over, clutching her stomach like she's been gutted.

Footsteps echo in the darkness. A low, menacing voice cuts through the night.

VOICE #1 (O.S.)
What do we have there?

VOICE #2 (O.S.)
Looks like a pretty little thing all alone...

Elsa slowly stands up and scans the shadows. Two dark figures emerge from behind the trees.

The figure lunges forward. Elsa screams desperately.

ELSA
HELP!

EP 17

35 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT** 35

Dylan paces like a caged animal, constantly glancing at his watch. Veronica lounges on the couch, amused.

VERONICA
Relax, darling. She's probably having lots of fun.

DYLAN
(snapping)
Fuck this. I'm going after her.

He strides toward the door. But immediately, he freezes at the door. He sees two figures approach.

Elsa is being half-carried by ANDY HAY(22, golden college boy). Her hair is a mess, dress torn at the shoulder.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(exploding)
What the HELL -Get off her!

Without warning, Dylan RIPS Elsa from Andy's arms, clutching her against his chest like she's made of glass.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Who are you? What did you do to her?

ANDY
(hands up, startled)
Whoa, dude! I helped her! Found her being harassed by some creeps in the park—

ELSA
(breathless, still shaken)
Dylan, stop it! He saved me!

She struggles weakly against Dylan's iron grip.

ELSA (CONT'D)
(pushing at his chest)
Let me GO! Don't act like you care!

DYLAN
Elsa, this is not the time for that...

ELSA
(voice rising, getting breathless)
You already made your choice! So don’t YOU dare-

Her eyes roll back. Her body goes limp in Dylan's arms.

DYLAN
ELSA! NO!

EP 18

36 **INT. DYLAN’S HOUSE - ELSA'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 36

Dylan paces by the window, his hair is disheveled.

DYLAN
(to the phone)
Doctor, are you sure? Just shock and fever?

DOCTOR (O.S.)
She gets fragile because of her childhood illness but she’ll be fine. She’s just shaken up and completely exhausted.

Dylan hangs up, slumping against the wall.

A soft moan breaks the silence. Elsa tosses restlessly, kicking off her blanket. Sweat beads on her forehead.

ELSA
No...no...

Dylan rushes to her side, gently pulling the blanket back up.

DYLAN
(gently whispering)
It's okay. Elsa, you're safe now.

Elsa's hand reaches out blindly, searching.

ELSA
(weak, confused)
Dylan...Where are you...

Dylan's mask crumbles. He can't hold back anymore.

DYLAN
(voice breaking)
I'm here, baby. I'm right here.

He climbs onto the bed, pulling her into his arms.

ELSA
You promised...you'll be with me...

DYLAN
Yes, I'll be with you. Forever.

Elsa melts into his embrace. He watches her sleep, then presses a tender kiss to her forehead.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
If only I could keep that promise...

EP 19

37 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - ELSA'S BEDROOM - MORNING** 37

Elsa's eyes flutter open. Dylan's jacket is draped over her like a blanket. She sits up, touching the fabric.

ELSA
He actually stayed all night...

38 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 38

Elsa finds Dylan setting breakfast on the table. His walls are back up - cold, professional. Dylan sees her, apparently embarrassed.

DYLAN
You're up. Breakfast is ready.

Elsa stares at him. But Dylan is avoiding her.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(turning around from her)
Don't be stupid again. Running off could've gotten you killed.

Elsa isn't buying his attitude. She walks straight up to him.

ELSA
Cut the bullshit, UNCLE Dylan.

She grabs his tie, yanking him down until their faces are inches apart.

ELSA (CONT'D)
Your words lie, but your body never.

She pulls him even closer, as if they are about to kiss.

DYLAN
(surprised, breathless)
What are you doing?

Elsa doesn’t answer but staring at him. Her hands trail down his chest slowly. She presses closer, wrapping her leg around his.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(voice strained)
Where did you learn this kind of...

ELSA
(whisper to him)
In my dreams. With you. A thousand times.

Dylan's face flushes red. He grabs her wrists, trying to create distance.

DYLAN
(struggling)
We can't do this. Stop...

But Elsa presses her body fully against his and slowly grinds her hips against him. Dylan's breath catches. His grip on her wrists loosens.

ELSA
No. Unless you tell me this doesn't feel good. That you don't want me...

Dylan closes his eyes, fighting a losing battle. His body betrays him. He gives in. He wraps his arm around her waist, pulling her impossibly closer.

DYLAN
Elsa, you're making me do this...
This is on you.

ELSA
(triumphant)
Yes, all on me. So... Give it to me.

They lean in, lips almost touching...

DING DONG!

The doorbell cuts through. Dylan jerks back and shoves Elsa away so hard she stumbles. He looks at the door in panic.

EP 20

39 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 39

Dylan opens the door. JOE LANCASTER (60s) stands there in an expensive suit, with pure old-money arrogance.

JOE
(scanning the room with disgust)
Jesus, Dylan. This place looks like a camp tent.

His cold eyes land on Elsa.

JOE (CONT'D)
(dismissive)
Still playing house with the charity case, I see.

DYLAN
(sarcastic)
Well, Father. Between campaigning and counting your money, you actually remembered I exist.

JOE
Good. At least you're paying attention to your old man's career. I need you, son. Time to come home.

DYLAN
(bitter laugh)
What could you possibly need from a "lowly teacher"?

JOE
Don't be smart with me. You're going to move back, marry someone useful, and help me win this governor election...

He glances at Elsa with disgust.

JOE (CONT'D)
Instead of wasting time and money on this... project of yours.

Elsa's face crumples.

JOE (CONT'D)
She's a leech, Dylan. Sucking you dry while contributing nothing.

Elsa’s in shame. She lowers her head. But soon Dylan strides over to Elsa and determinedly takes her hand.

DYLAN
I have zero interest in your campaign, your money, or your fucking political games.

He steps forward and raises his head.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Elsa will ALWAYS be the most important person in my life.

Dylan doesn't flinch, his grip on Elsa's hand tightening.

JOE
(cold laugh)
Pathetic. You have no sense of value.
(walk to the door)
You are going to the Education Foundation gala tomorrow for my campaign. This is your duty.

He exits, leaving Dylan and Elsa in stunned silence.

40 **INT. GRAND BALLROOM - NIGHT** 40

Elsa enters with Dylan wearing a simple dress like an ordinary college girl. Her eyes immediately find VERONICA, stunning in a designer gown, holding court like a queen.

Joe walks towards them in a very good mood.

JOE
Son! I heard the wonderful news about you two!

He pulls Veronica possessively to Dylan's side.

JOE (CONT'D)
Perfect match. Old money, good breeding. This is exactly what the campaign needs!

VERONICA
(purring)
We're so happy to find each other too, aren't we, darling?

She loops her arm through Dylan's. His jaw clenches.

ELSA
(frowns to Dylan)
Are you REALLY gonna marry her?

EP 21

Dylan is about to refuse but Veronica gives him a threatening look. Dylan sighs and stays quiet. Veronica approaches Elsa.

VERONICA
Since Dylan treats you like his little sister, maybe I'll be your sister-in-law soon.

Elsa's face burns with humiliation and rage.

ELSA
Go to hell.

She storms off. Dylan instinctively moves to follow.

VERONICA
Behave. You know what I can do.

41 **INT. BAR - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 41

Elsa downs shot after shot, apparently tipsy. A SLEAZY MAN (40s) slides up beside her.

SLEAZY MAN
Easy there, beautiful. You're gonna hurt yourself drinking like that.

ELSA
(slurring)
...good. That’s exactly what I need.

SLEAZY MAN
Come on, let me help you somewhere quiet. You need to lie down.

In her drunken state, Elsa nods and stumbles after him.

42 **INT. EMPTY ROOM - NIGHT - MOMENTS LATER** 42

The man pushes Elsa onto the couch. She realizes the danger too late.

ELSA
(panicked, struggling)
NO! Get off me!

SLEAZY MAN
(pinning her down)
Relax, sweetheart. It'll be fun...

CRASH! The door EXPLODES open. Dylan stands there, absolutely feral. He kicks the man directly in the groin. The man crumples, screaming.

DYLAN
(murderous rage)
GET YOUR FUCKING HANDS OFF HER!

EP 22

43 **INT. EMPTY ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 43

The sleazy man limps out, clutching his injury and muttering curses. Dylan helps Elsa to her feet with controlled fury.

DYLAN
(cold, controlled)
We are leaving. Now.

But Elsa is still drunk, her inhibitions completely gone. Clung tightly to Dylan, her body is pressed against his.

ELSA
Dylan...is that you? Why won't you look at me? Really look at me?

DYLAN
(maintaining distance)
You're drunk, Elsa. We need to get you home.

ELSA
(defiant, clinging to him)
I'm not going anywhere with you! You don’t love me anyways!

Dylan tries to push her away a little, but she holds him unbelievably tight.

DYLAN
Enough Elsa... Don’t touch my...

Her hand shaking yet delicately follows his body down to his sensitive part.

ELSA
I know exactly what I'm doing! I'm not a child anymore!

Suddenly, Joe's voice echoes from the hallway.

JOE (O.S.)
Dylan! Where the hell are you? We have donors waiting!

Panic flashes across Dylan's face. Elsa, still drunk, doesn't realize and keeps touching. He can barely hold it anymore.

ELSA
(even louder)
Am I just some burden to you? Does none of THIS mean anything?

She's getting louder and more emotional. Joe is right outside the door. Dylan makes a desperate choice.

He cups her face and kisses her urgently to quiet her. Elsa freezes, her eyes widen with shock. The world stops a beat.

ELSA (CONT'D)
Dylan...?

The two can’t stop but keep kissing, now romantically, as if they’ve waited a lifetime.

EP 23

44 **INT. EMPTY ROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 44

Elsa melts into the kiss, her whole world reduced to this single moment. But as Joe's voice fades down the corridor, Dylan abruptly shoves her away.

Elsa is getting sober, reaching for him.

DYLAN
(backing away, cold)
Elsa, this, us, has to stop.

ELSA
(desperate)
Why! I feel it! You feel it!

Dylan straightens his tie.

DYLAN
Fantasies need to stay fantasies.

Dylan walks away, leaves Elsa standing there, shattered.

45 **INT. GRAND BALLROOM - NIGHT - MOMENTS LATER** 45

Elsa stumbles back into the gala, still reeling. On stage, Joe taps his champagne glass.

JOE
(booming voice)
Ladies and gentlemen, I am proud to share that my son Dylan and lovely Veronica will be announcing their engagement next month!

The crowd erupts in applause. Elsa feels the world tilt. She rushes towards Dylan.

ELSA
NO! This can't be happening!

The entire ballroom falls silent. All eyes turn to her.

JOE
(furious, embarrassed)
Security! Remove her immediately!

DYLAN
(stepping forward)
Father! Please, leave her to me...

VERONICA
(gripping Dylan's arm, hissing)
One word to defend her, and I'll tell everyone exactly what you did.

Dylan freezes, trapped.

JOE
(approaching Elsa)
You greedy little girl. Haven’t you sucked enough out of him?

All eyes turn to Dylan.

VERONICA
(deadly sweet)
Dylan darling, don’t you also have something to say to her?

She waves the USB at Dylan. He closes his eyes desperately.

DYLAN
Elsa, you are just... a burden I inherited. We're from completely different worlds. You can never understand my life.

ELSA
(shaking)
Dylan, really? ...Have I stood in the way of your success? Am I just your burden?

DYLAN
(bitter laugh)
Yes.

ELSA
(heartbreaking)
I see.

In the stillness, she turns and walks out. Dylan collapsed to his knees, burying his face in his hands in pain.

EP 24

46 **EXT. OUTSIDE DYLAN’S HOUSE - DAY** 46

Elsa loads suitcases into her car. She is determined.

ANDY approaches cautiously.

ANDY
Hey... You again! Elsa, right? You look like hell. What happened?

ELSA
(weak)
Andy, hey. Nothing...just need to move out of this place.

ANDY
(concerned)
Is this about that Professor? You’re leaving him?

A bitter laugh appears on Elsa’s face.

ANDY (CONT'D)
Look, hear me out. I'm gay. Like, 100% pure gay. So this isn't me hitting on you or anything.

Elsa looks at him, surprised but not shocked.

ELSA
(softly)
Okay. Thanks for telling me.

ANDY
(sincere)
You seem like you need a friend right now, and a place to stay.

ELSA
(voice breaking)
Oh...Andy, I really don’t know how to thank you.

ANDY
Don't worry about it. We all have days when we could use a hand. Let me get your stuff.

Andy helps her carrying boxes.

Dylan arrives home and runs to Elsa and grabs her wrist.

DYLAN
What the hell are you doing?

Elsa jerks his hand away, shooting him a furious glare.

ELSA
None of your business!

EP 25

47 **EXT. OUTSIDE DYLAN’S HOUSE - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 47

Elsa turns away and keeps herself busy.

ELSA
(not looking at him)
This is you and your fiancee's house now. No room for an unwanted orphan.

DYLAN
I never said that.
(pointing to Andy)
(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)
And why is HE here? Is he your boyfriend now?

ELSA
(ice cold)
Why do you care?

DYLAN
(jealous rage)
Are you moving in with him? You barely know him! You know how dangerous that is?

ANDY
Hey, Professor, calm down...

DYLAN
SHUT UP!

Elsa whirls around, fury blazing in her eyes.

ELSA
Don’t talk to him like that!

Dylan stares at her seriously.

DYLAN
Are you mad at me because of him?

ELSA
This has nothing to do with him! It’s YOU! It’s always YOU!

She pulls out Dylan's credit card and keys and throws it at his feet.

ELSA (CONT'D)
I won't take another penny from you. We're done.

She turns away into the car with Andy. As they drive away, Dylan stands alone in the driveway.

DYLAN
(broken whisper)
What have I done...

EP 26

48 **EXT. CAMPUS - DAY** 48

Elsa walks along with Andy.

ELSA
(disgusted)
Veronica must have already moved into the house. It makes me sick just thinking about it.

ANDY
Elsa, maybe you should just let it go—

ELSA
I’m trying! But I'm going back tonight to get my photos. The ones of me and Dylan... I won’t let Veronica touch any of those.

49 **INT. DYLAN’S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - NIGHT** 49

Veronica sits elegantly on the couch, pouring wine. She discreetly slips a small pill into one glass, stirring it carefully.

VERONICA
(sweet)
You look exhausted, darling. All this stress about the engagement party...

She offers Dylan the drugged glass. He waves it away.

DYLAN
Please leave. I have work to do.

VERONICA
(manipulative)
Come on. If Elsa were here, she'd want you to relax. She always worried about you working too hard.

At the mention of Elsa's name, Dylan's defenses crack. He sighs and drinks it down. Veronica watches with satisfaction.

VERONICA (V.O.)
Perfect. I’ve slipped something special in his drink. Tonight, he’ll be mine.

VERONICA
(moving closer)
Our engagement is official. Maybe I should stay tonight. Take care of you.

She trails her fingers down his chest. Dylan's vision starts to blur, but he jerks away from her touch.

DYLAN
(struggling)
No... I don't... I can't...

Veronica presses against him, but Dylan grips the couch arm, fighting the drug's effects.

VERONICA
Don’t fight it, darling. Embrace it with me...

She tries to hold him, but Dylan keeps pushing her away. He stumbles toward the door.

DYLAN
No... NO!

He shoves her toward the exit, then locks the door.

VERONICA (O.S.)
(furious, from outside)
Don't be ridiculous! Open the door!

Dylan collapses against the door, sliding down to the floor.

50 **EXT. DYLAN’S HOUSE - LIVING ROOM CORNER - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 50

Elsa sneaks in through the window. She freezes when she sees Dylan collapsed by the front door.

She rushes to his side as he lies unconscious on the floor.

ELSA
(panicked)
Dylan!

EP 27

51 **INT. DYLAN’S HOUSE - DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 51

Elsa kneels beside Dylan, trying to lift him. He's flushed, breathing heavily.

ELSA
(struggling)
Come on, let’s go to bed.

She manages to drag him to his bed. Dylan's eyes flutter open, unfocused.

DYLAN
(dazed, vulnerable)
Elsa... my, Elsa...

Elsa freezes for a bit, then continues to help with his clothes.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Am I dreaming?

ELSA
You're drunk. And pathetic.

Dylan grabs Elsa’s wrist. His wall has gone down. He tries to pull her into his arms, but she struggles, wriggling free.

ELSA (CONT'D)
This is not helping, Uncle Dylan.

DYLAN
Why...I’m not crazy, or maybe I am. Crazy about you. Crazy for pretending I don't need you. Crazy for pushing you away...

His words leaves Elsa momentarily confused, frozen in place. In that instant, Dylan pulls her onto the bed, and pins her tightly beneath him. Elsa cannot even breathe.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
You’re still mad at me? Even when you're angry, you're still the most beautiful girl I've ever seen...

One of his hands holds Elsa tightly around her waist, while the other slowly and teasingly traces over her chest, along her waist, and further down.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Every single part of you...

ELSA
(voice shaking)
Have you lost your mind?

DYLAN
(breathless)
I have. Every time I saw you... I lost myself...

He is almost whispering into Elsa's ear, making her blush and breathe faster. Their bodies presses tightly together, too close to resist any longer.

ELSA
Don't trick me just because you are drunk. I haven't forgiven you yet.

She tries to push him away, But Dylan is too strong. He suddenly lowers his head and kisses her desperately.

Elsa is completely stunned by his unprecedented passion and assertiveness, her eyes wide open, not knowing what to do.

EP 28

52 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 52

Dylan's kiss turns frantic, his hands touching Elsa shaking as the drug tears away his control.

Elsa is shocked by his intensity, hesitates to enjoy.

Dylan's kisses grows more intense, his movements more urgent as he tear at her clothes and his own. His hands are moving down, almost get into her pants...

Like an electric shock, Elsa pushes him back, breathing hard.

ELSA
(desperate)
You are really confusing me right now. What exactly are you doing? What do you want from me!

Dylan looks at her with raw pain and longing.

DYLAN
What do I want from you...

His movement becomes gentle. He touches her face, as if that's his most valuable thing.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
I just want to love you. I just want you... to be MINE.

The words hit Elsa like lightning.

ELSA
Dylan...do you really mean it?

She holds his face, stares at him deeply.

ELSA (CONT'D)
You know... once you say it, I can't refuse.

The moment the words fall, the room sinks into utter silence.

In the very next breath, Dylan moves with a directness he has never shown before. He pulls her into his arms deeply. His kisses and touches pours down on her like a storm—fierce, relentless, leaving no space for hesitation or retreat.

Elsa no longer resists. She responds to Dylan with burning passion, pulling off his clothes.

Amid their fierce movements, both their faces are lit with a mix of longing and fulfillment.

EP 29

53 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - DYLAN'S BEDROOM - MORNING** 53

Elsa lies awake, a blissful smile on her face. She traces patterns on Dylan's chest as he sleeps peacefully beside her.

ELSA (V.O.)
Last night... every touch, every moment. It was everything I ever imagined and more.

She watches Dylan's face, completely content.

ELSA (V.O.)
He's finally mine! We're finally together!

She leans down and plants a soft kiss on his forehead. Dylan's eyes flutter open.

ELSA
(smiling, cuddling closer)
Good morning, my love.

She nestles against him playfully.

Dylan almost jumps. He sits up. His eyes suddenly focus. He sees their scattered clothes and falls into fear.

DYLAN
What happened? Why are you...?

Disoriented, Dylan sees Elsa beside him, but his memories are hazy. He looks around the room and pieces together what happened. His confusion turns to fury.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(shouting to himself)
How could I let this happen?! I swore I wouldn't touch her!

ELSA
(panicked)
I don't care! I love you! Don't you love me too?

DYLAN
(forcing coldness)
No. I won't break my promise. I don't have ANY romantic feelings for you. Not at all.

Elsa stares at him, her heart shattering. Tears stream down her face.

ELSA
No...I can’t believe this...

Dylan can’t face her, lowers his head.

DYLAN (V.O.)
I'm sorry, Elsa. I'm just not worthy of someone as precious as you.

EP 30

54 **INT. DYLAN’S HOUSE - DYLAN'S BEDROOM - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 54

Dylan stares at his hand in horror, realizing what he's done. But the panic overwhelms his regret.

DYLAN
(ice cold)
Tell me. What did you do!

Elsa touches her burning cheek, speechless.

ELSA
You... you don't remember?

DYLAN
(desperate, demanding)
Answer me! Did we sleep together or not?

Elsa stares at him in disbelief, her heart is broken.

ELSA
(hurt and angry)
No! NOTHING happened! You're disappointed, aren't you? That you might have actually shown me some love for once!

Dylan's relief is visible, but his anger doesn't subside.

DYLAN
Do you have any idea how pathetic this is? Tossing yourself at me like trash? GET OUT!

Elsa staggers backward, her face a portrait of devastation. She grabs her clothes and runs out in tears. The door slams.

Dylan sinks onto the bed, head in his hands.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
I’m so sorry, Elsa. But this is the only way to make you let go...

EP 31

55 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY** 55

Veronica comes in. She approaches Dylan with her usual predatory smile.

VERONICA
Darling, we need to discuss the engagement party details—

Dylan's rage explodes. He corners her to the wall.

DYLAN
(murderous)
What did you put in my drink last night?

VERONICA
(gasping but smirking)
I don’t know what you are talking about. Nothing happened, right?

DYLAN
(tightening his grip)
We're DONE. I'm calling off this engagement. Stay away from me!

VERONICA
You think it's that easy? Your father needs my family's power and connections!

She pushes him off, straightening her clothes.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
And you? You're under MY control now. What would they say if they found out what you did to that poor orphan girl?

DYLAN
You are poison.

VERONICA
(smiles)
I'm training you. You can't escape me honey. I always get what I want.

She strides off in glamorous glory.

56 **INT. HALLWAY - DAY - LATER** 56

Veronica walks angrily in the hallway.

VERONICA (V.O.)
That little bitch drove Dylan and me apart. Looks like she needs some warning, or she'll keep crawling back from the ashes forever.

She pulls out her phone.

VERONICA
Girls? Come to my office now. Time to play with Miss Elsa.

EP 32

57 **EXT. CAMPUS - DAY** 57

Elsa walks across campus, confused by the stares and whispers following her everywhere.

STUDENT #1 (O.S.)
That's her...

STUDENT #2 (O.S.)
Can't believe she has the nerve to show her face.

Elsa quickens her pace, anxiety building.

Around the corner, Elsa stops. Plastered across the board are FLYERS with her face photoshopped onto explicit images.

58 FLYER TEXT: "ELSA LOCKHART - CAMPUS ESCORT - SOLID PROOF" 58

Students crowd around, some laughing, others taking photos with their phones.

ANNA
Wow, look who’s here!

MONICA
(mocking)
Business must be slow if she needs flyers!

LAURA
How much for an hour, Elsa? Student discount?

The crowd erupts in laughter. Someone throws a water bottle at Elsa.

STUDENTS (O.S.)
Slut! Get off our campus!

Andy pushes through the crowd, shielding Elsa.

ANDY
(fierce)
Back off! All of you!

Nobody listens. More people join, hurling insults and trash.

59 **EXT. CAMPUS - ACROSS THE COURTYARD - DAY - SAME TIME** 59

Dylan watches from a distance, his face contorted with rage and pain. Finally, he decides to walk towards the crowds. But Veronica grabs his arm.

VERONICA
I would be careful if I were you.

Dylan freezes.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
Unless you want her getting accused of having an affair with a professor on top of her slut label.

Dylan watches helplessly as Elsa crumbles under the assault. His fists clench so hard his knuckles go white.

DYLAN
I’m not done with this!

60 **EXT. CAMPUS - DAY - LATER** 60

Anna, Monica, and Laura walk together at a quiet corner, still laughing about their “prank”.

ANNA
Did you see her face? Priceless!

LAURA
I got it all on video. This is going viral!

Suddenly, Dylan steps out from behind a car, blocking their path. His expression is absolutely feral.

DYLAN
(ice cold)
Let’s see who’s going viral.

EP 33

61 **EXT. CAMPUS - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 61

Dylan has cornered Anna, Monica, and Laura in a narrow alley between buildings. He’s furious.

ANNA
(defiant but nervous)
You can't touch us! You are a professor! And we have people in the school board!

Dylan steps closer, his eyes wild with rage.

DYLAN
(voice deadly calm)
I don't give a damn about your connections. I don’t care about the consequences.

The girls' bravado crumbles as they see something terrifying in his expression.He's now inches from their faces.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(whispered threat)
The only thing I care about is making you three pay for what you did. With your lives if necessary.

Anna starts crying. Monica tries to run but Dylan grabs her.

LAURA
Wha...what do you want!

DYLAN
Your phones. Now.

62 **EXT. CAMPUS - ANOTHER CORNER - DAY - SAME TIME** 62

Elsa stands in the center of a hostile crowd, her clothes splattered with paint and mud. Students continue hurling insults and debris.

STUDENTS
Whore! Whore! Get out! Get out!

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON approaches with security guards, his face stern.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
Miss Lockhart! Due to your inappropriate conduct and the damage to this university's reputation, you are hereby expelled effective immediately!

The crowd erupts in cheers and applause.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON (CONT'D)
Security will escort you off campus. You are no longer welcome here.

Elsa stands there, completely defeated, tears running down.

ELSA
Those pictures are fake! I didn't do anything!

No one listens. The crowds are shouting and laughing.

Just as security walks up to her, a deep voice cuts through.

DYLAN (O.S.)
(commanding)
STOP!

Everyone freezes, turning toward him.

EP 34

63 **EXT. CAMPUS - ANOTHER CORNER - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 63

Dylan emerges from the crowd, striding forward with purpose. His clothes are disheveled, his expression fierce.

DYLAN
(loud, commanding)
The photos are fake. The rumors are lies. All of it.

The crowd murmurs in confusion. The Dean looks annoyed.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
Professor Lancaster, this is a serious matter, do you have proof?

DYLAN
Of course, Principal.

He pulls out three phones, holding them up.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
These belong to Anna Peterson, Monica Williams, and Laura Hash. Check their messages, photo editing apps, and group chats.

He hands the phones to Principal.

Behind him, three girls stand together with their heads down.

The Principal scrolls through one phone, his expression changing rapidly.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
(shocked)
Oh my goodness, this is unbelievable. You three! My office now!

The three girls are dragged away, sobbing.

Elsa stands there, paint-stained but vindicated.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON (CONT'D)
(to Elsa, apologetic)
Miss Lockhart, my apologies. We will investigate how this harassment was allowed to escalate.

The crowd disperses, ashamed. Students who were laughing moments ago now avoid eye contact.

Elsa finally let out a sigh of relief. But the moment her eyes fell on Dylan, her heart began to race wildly again.

Dylan walks to her. After a beat, he hugs her.

DYLAN
It’s okay, Elsa...It’s okay now.

The moment Elsa touched him, a sense of safety and warmth washed over her. Her eyes grew misty, yet a faint, relieved smile appears on her face.

But suddenly, her face goes pale. She pushes Dylan away and runs to the back of the bushes.

She doubles over and vomits violently onto the ground.

ELSA (V.O.)
Oh, no...

Her hand instinctively goes to her stomach as the horrible truth hits her.

EP 35

64 **EXT. CAMPUS - ANOTHER CORNER - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 64

ELSA tries to stop her vomiting. She stands up quickly, pale and sweating. DYLAN catches up. ELSA grips her books tighter, gives a fake smile.

DYLAN
Elsa, I know things have been complicated between us lately... but you saw what happened today. You are not safe by yourself.

ELSA
(forcing coldness, swallowing hard)
I’m fine on my own.

DYLAN
You're not fine! Come home with me.

ELSA
No! That’s not my home anymore.

DYLAN
Stop acting like a child!

ELSA spins around, anger flashing despite her sickness.

ELSA
This is exactly why I’m not coming with you.

She sways, overcome by nausea, and suddenly collapses.

DYLAN
(surprised)
ELSA!

He holds Elsa in his arms.

65 **INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - DAY** 65

ELSA's eyes flutter open. DOCTOR sits beside her.

DOCTOR
(nods)
Miss Lockheart, you are pregnant. Four weeks already. You need some good rest, I’ll prepare some medicine for you.

As he leaves, Elsa touches her own stomach and smiles softly.

ELSA (V.O.)
Pregnant...with Dylan’s child! I never expected this after that night with him. But this is the only gift he'll ever give me. I'll protect you, little one.

The door suddenly BURSTS open. DYLAN storms in, eyes bloodshot with rage. VERONICA follows behind, smirking.

Dylan trembles as he looks at Elsa, his hands gripping her shoulders with barely controlled emotion.

ELSA
(shaking)
Dylan...

Dylan is so furious, his whole body is shaking.

DYLAN
(screaming)
Is that really all you’re worth?

Elsa covers her face, her expression a mix of disbelief and heartbreak.

EP 36

66 **INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 66

Elsa stares at Dylan with disbelieving eyes, grip too strong. He's never been like this - wild, unhinged, terrifying.

DYLAN
(losing control, voice shaking with rage)
Whose baby is it?! That college pretty boy? Andy? Did you sleep with him?!

Elsa's mouth opens and closes helplessly. She meets eyes with Veronica, who is apparently thrilled to witness this drama.

ELSA (V.O.)
Should I tell him the truth? That it's his child? But Veronica's watching... I can't destroy his future.

Elsa stammers, unable to form words.

DYLAN
(betrayed, furious)
You just met him and you just...? Do you have any goddamn self-respect left? How could you become so disgusting!

Each word hits ELSA like a physical blow. She stares at this vicious stranger wearing her beloved Dylan's face.

ELSA
Is this how you look at me? A cheap...disgusting slut?

DYLAN
(screaming now, completely unhinged)
I told you you were more important than my pathetic life! But you've changed. And you said you loved me - is this how you show love? Sleeping around and getting pregnant?

Something dies in Elsa's eyes. Her face hardens into a mask of cold devastation.

ELSA
I...I changed?
(bitter smile)
Fine, I'll change. From this moment, I will never love you again. I don't need you to take care of me, or feel responsible, or pity me...

She tries her best to stand up. She stands right in front of Dylan with her eyes staring deeply into his.

ELSA (CONT'D)
Goodbye forever, Uncle Dylan.

She leaves the bed on shaky legs, moving toward the door with heartbreaking dignity.

Veronica can't help but laugh behind her.

Dylan lets out a roar of anguish and slams his fist into the metal bed frame with a sickening CRACK.

EP 37

67 **EXT. OUTSIDE CAMPUS CAFE - DAY** 67

Andy walks alongside Elsa, carrying her bag. Her face is pale but determined.

ANDY
(studying her face)
You sure you're feeling okay?

ELSA
I'm fine. And I need to make some money for the baby.

ANDY
(sighs)
But... Are you absolutely sure about this? Raising the baby alone? Not telling Dylan the truth?

ELSA
(sadly, looking away)
You know, after all these, I'm not even sure if I really know him... Maybe he's right. We really are from different worlds.

She places both hands protectively over her stomach.

ELSA (CONT'D)
At least he gifted a treasure. I will do anything to for this baby.

68 **INT. CAMPUS CAFE - DAY** 68

Elsa is wiping the floor. Her movements are careful and deliberate, protecting her stomach.

Suddenly, scalding hot coffee splashes across her chest. She cries out in pain.

ELSA
Ahh!

She looks up to see Veronica standing over her with a mug, wearing a cruel, satisfied smirk.

VERONICA
Oops. My bad.

Elsa looks up in pain, coffee dripping from her shirt.

EP 38

69 **INT. CAMPUS CAFE - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 69

Elsa clutches her burned chest, looking at Veronica in shock and pain.

VERONICA
(fake concern)
Oh my God, I'm so sorry! But I guess... you're used to cleaning up messes, right? Miss Trashy.

Elsa's hands shake with suppressed rage as she struggles to her feet.

ELSA
(Voice trembling)
I’m not a threat to you anymore. Why are you still doing this to me?

VERONICA
(laughing coldly)
Doing what to you? You were never a threat, you pathetic little mouse. You're nothing but trash to me. What are you gonna do about it? Run crying to the principal? Or crawl back to your precious Professor?

Veronica steps closer.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
Nobody's on your side anymore.

The cafe’s door chimes open. Dylan walks in with several other professors, deep in conversation.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
(waving cheerfully)
Hi darling! I’m here!

Dylan's eyes immediately find Elsa across the room. Their gazes lock - his filled with conflicted pain, hers with panic and hurt.

Elsa quickly looks away and hurries toward the back.

70 **INT. CAMPUS CAFE KITCHEN - DAY - MOMENTS LATER** 70

Elsa frantically tries to clean the coffee stains from her uniform around her chest with a wet towel, her hands shaking. Tears of frustration stream down her face.

Suddenly, a large male hand presses tight from behind.

ELSA
(shouts out)
Who’s there!

EP 39

71 **INT. CAMPUS CAFE KITCHEN - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 71

Elsa spins around in panic to see MR.JOHNSON leering at her.

ELSA
Mr Johnson! What are you doing here!

MR.JOHNSON
What happened? Your uniform is all wet. Clumsy girl, Let me help you.

He steps closer, his intentions clear.

ELSA
(backing away, covering herself)
Mr. Johnson, please stay back! I can handle this myself!

MR.JOHNSON
(aggressive, grabbing her uniform)
Stop pretending! Everyone knows that you’re just a loose girl, sleeping around...

Elsa tries to pull back, but he leans closer and tries again.

MR.JOHNSON (CONT'D)
Be a good girl and you can have anything you want. I’ll make you feel good. I have experience... I know how to make you happy...

Elsa SCREAMS and struggles violently, trying to break free.

ELSA
Get away from me!

Suddenly, the door EXPLODES open with a thunderous BANG.

Dylan stands in the doorway, his face a mask of deadly fury. In one fluid motion, Dylan's fist hits Mr. Johnson's jaw, sending him to the corner wall.

DYLAN
(voice like ice)
Touch her again and you're dead.

Elsa stares at Dylan in shock, still trembling.

EP 40

72 **INT. CAMPUS CAFE KITCHEN - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 72

Mr. moans like a kid, clutching his bleeding nose. Dylan towers over him with cold, controlled rage.

DYLAN
(voice dangerously calm)
Harassing a student worker... Should I report you to the principal OR the police?

Mr. Johnson's face goes pale.

MR.JOHNSON
Look, Professor Lancaster, it was just a misunderstanding-

DYLAN
(nodding toward the exit)
Get out. Before I change my mind.

Mr. Johnson scrambles out of the kitchen.

The silence stretches between Elsa and Dylan, thick with unspoken tension and pain. Elsa frantically tries to fix her torn uniform, her hands shaking.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(staring at the floor)
I was just bluffing. He has backgrounds at school. This may happen again. Quit today.

ELSA
(bitter)
I don’t need to listen to you.

DYLAN
Put away your attitude! Don’t let your emotions get in the way! I’m doing all this for your own safety!

ELSA
(raises her voice)
I DON’T NEED THAT!

Dylan looks at her with anger in his eyes too.

DYLAN
Don't put on this act with me, Elsa! You said you loved me! Just let me take care of you!

Elsa's face crumples with hurt and rage. Suddenly she shoves Dylan with all her strength.

ELSA
(sobbing with fury)
It’s too late for that.

EP 41

73 **INT. CAMPUS CAFE KITCHEN - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 73

Elsa stares at him.

ELSA
I wish I never loved you.

She pushes past him and runs out of the kitchen, leaving him standing alone.

Dylan slowly raises his hand to his stinging cheek.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Yeah, Dylan Lancaster. You ARE a bastard. As soon as you see her, you lose your damn mind.

He slams his fist against the door with a resounding CLANG, his face twisted with regret and pain.

74 **INT. DYLAN'S OFFICE - DAY** 74

Joe Lancaster sits in the middle of the room, holding Veronica’s hand and chatting with her affectionately. Dylan stands a little distance away, growing impatient.

DYLAN
Why are you here during my working hour, Father?

JOE
Your wedding with Veronica needs to happen next month. No delays.

DYLAN
(startled)
What? Why?

Joe's eyes gleam with political calculation.

JOE
(carefully choosing words)
My campaign for governor hinges on securing the education vote. Veronica’s father controls a powerful bloc that could guarantee my victory.

VERONICA
(sliding closer to Dylan, voice saccharine)
I’d LOVE to help. Together, our families could easily reshape this entire election.

Joe nods enthusiastically while Dylan looks disgusted.

DYLAN
This is insane. I won't be part of your deal.

JOE
(exploding with rage)
You don't get a choice! It's about our family's legacy, your career and reputation! You WILL do this!

Dylan leaves the room with anger.

75 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT** 75

Dylan trudges into his dark bedroom, emotionally drained. He flicks on the light switch.

DYLAN'S FANTASY BEGINS:

Suddenly, warm golden lamplight illuminates the room. There, lying on his bed in white dress, is Elsa. She looks both innocent and seductive, like an angel waiting for him.

Dylan freezes in the doorway, panting in hope.

DYLAN
(whispered, disbelieving)
Elsa...?

EP 42

76 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 76

Elsa sits gracefully on the bed, the warm lamplight casting a golden glow on her delicate features. Her voice is like silk.

ELSA
(softly, extending her hand)
Dylan...

DYLAN
(breathless, stepping closer)
How are you here? I thought you never wanted to see me again.

Elsa's lips curve into an enchanting smile as she rises from the bed, moving toward him.

ELSA
(playfully reproachful)
That's only because you were so mean to me. Why can't you just tell me what's really in your heart?

She reaches him and presses herself against his chest, her arms wrapping around his neck.

ELSA (CONT'D)
(whispering against his ear)
You're such a naughty liar, Dylan. You love me, don't you?

Dylan's body immediately responds to her closeness, his breathing becoming ragged.

Elsa's fingers trace the contours of his face with feather-light touches, then slowly trail down from his chest, his waist, and under. Dylan shudders as if struck by lightning.

ELSA (CONT'D)
(voice husky with desire)
You missed me so much... missed my lips, my touch, my body...

She tilts her face up toward his, lips parted invitingly. Dylan's eyes flutter closed as he leans down to meet her kiss.

The moment their lips are about to touch, the warm light suddenly vanishes.

DYLAN'S FANTASY ENDS

Dylan's eyes snap open. He's alone, kneeling on the cold floor beside his bed. A picture frame lies face-down on the floor.

With trembling hands, he picks it up - it's a photo of him and Elsa.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Elsa...what have I done?

Something fierce ignites in his eyes. He grips the frame tightly and strides toward the door with sudden determination.

DYLAN (V.O.)
No! I can't lose her! I JUST CAN'T!

77 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - HALLWAY - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 77

He yanks open the door, ready to rush out -

Veronica stands in the doorway, her hand immediately snatching the photo from his grasp.

VERONICA
Going somewhere, darling?

Dylan stares at her in shock, caught red-handed.

EP 43

78 **INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE - HALLWAY - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 78

Dylan tries to push past Veronica, but she clutches the photo frame possessively.

VERONICA
(voice rising)
You're going to that little whore? You still can't forget her? Are you completely insane?!

DYLAN
(coldly amused)
Maybe I am.

VERONICA
(in complete rage)
I've been patient with you, Dylan, but don't mistake my kindness for weakness! I'M your fiancee!

DYLAN
(stepping closer, voice deadly calm)
I never actually approved that.

Veronica's composed mask completely shatters.

VERONICA
(screaming, losing all control)
You better watch yourself! We WILL get married! If you refuse, your father's fortune, your job, your entire fucking life will be destroyed!

DYLAN
(shrugging)
Go ahead and try. I'm not afraid. And as for my father? I couldn't care less about him.

VERONICA
(desperately vicious)
She's a child! Your student!
(MORE)

VERONICA (CONT'D)
When this gets out, your reputation is over! Is she worth losing everything?

Dylan stops and slowly turns around, a bitter, heartbroken smile crossing his face.

DYLAN
(voice breaking with raw emotion)
You're right. Elsa might destroy my life... But God help me, I love her more than everything.

He turns and runs out of the house. His silhouette disappears into the night.

Veronica lets out a primal scream and hurls the photo frame against the marble floor. It SHATTERS into a thousand glittering pieces.

EP 44

79 **INT. ANDY'S APARTMENT - BEDROOM - NIGHT** 79

Doorbell rings.

Andy opens the door to find Dylan standing there, disheveled and breathing heavily, his hair messy from running.

The two men lock eyes, immediate hostility crackling between them.

ANDY
(cold, blocking the doorway)
What the hell are you doing here?

DYLAN
(jaw clenched)
None of your business.

Dylan tries to push past Andy into the apartment, but Andy steps firmly in front of him, arms crossed

ANDY
Actually, it is my business. This is MY place!

DYLAN
I’m looking for MY Elsa!

The tension between Dylan and Andy is electric, both men bristling with barely contained aggression.

ANDY
Elsa is not yours.

DYLAN
(voice low and dangerous)
I need to see her. Now.

ANDY
(standing firm)
She's not feeling well and doesn't want to see anyone. Especially you.

DYLAN
(stepping closer, abandoning his usual composure)
Get out of my way, kid. This doesn't concern you.

ANDY
(chest puffing out, matching Dylan's intensity)
Like hell it doesn't. I won’t let you in. Every time you show up, all you bring her is pain. Why can't you leave her alone?

DYLAN
(eyes flashing with fury)
What about you? What exactly can you offer her? You irresponsibly got her pregnant!

ANDY
Me? Got her pregnant?

Dylan looks confused. He grabs Andy by the collar, pulls him close.

DYLAN
What do you mean?

EP 45

Andy looks at him with a cold laugh.

ANDY
You’ll regret what you said today.

Dylan steps forward aggressively, more furious.

DYLAN
Forget your attitude! Elsa's suffering every day because of pregnancy - all because of YOU! She was seriously sick when she's little, pregnancy is extremely dangerous for her! Did you even think about that before you selfishly used her?

ANDY
(laughing bitterly)
That's exactly what you should ask yourself, Professor.

DYLAN
(losing all control)
Am I wrong?! I'm done staring at your smug face!

ANDY
(equally enraged)
And I'm sick of yours!

Both men grab each other's shirts, faces inches apart, ready to throw punches.

Suddenly, Elsa's weak voice cuts through their rage.

ELSA
(weak)
Stop...stop it!

She tries to hold their hands, but after a loud THUD, she falls on the ground.

DYLAN & ANDY
(in panic)
ELSA!

Both men release each other and rush to hold her.

EP 46

80 **INT. ANDY'S APARTMENT - FRONT DOOR - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 80

Both men rush to Elsa's side. She struggles to stand with their help, but immediately leans into Andy's embrace, pushing Dylan away with her free hand.

ELSA
(weak but determined)
Andy's right. I already made myself clear to you. Please leave.

DYLAN
(concerned)
Elsa, I know you better than anyone! This is not what you want...you need me. You’re not okay! You’re suffering.

ELSA
(bitter smile)
What makes you think you know me so well, Uncle Dylan?

DYLAN
(desperate, reaching for her)
Stop acting like a little girl, Elsa. Come with me. You need a better place to live, professional care, and better doctors...

ELSA
(recoiling, protective hand over her stomach)
Stay away from me and my baby!

Dylan's face crumbles as he watches her cling to Andy.

DYLAN
(voice breaking)
Does this guy... and his baby, matter that much to you?

Elsa looks directly into Dylan's eyes, tears streaming down her cheeks.

ELSA
(voice trembling but resolute)
Yes. This baby, and the baby’s father are the most important people in my life.

Her tears fall freely as she speaks. Dylan stares at her, seeing the truth in her pain.

Dylan nods slowly, defeated.

DYLAN
(voice hollow)
I see. I was... fooling myself. I'm the one who's out of place here.

He forces a broken smile.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Elsa, I hope you... and your family, will be happy forever.

Dylan turns and walks out, closing the door softly behind him.

He leans against the door in the hallway, his composure finally breaking as tears stream down his face.

DYLAN (V.O.)
(heartbroken, confused)
She loved me so much, for so many years... What happened to her? What happened to US?

Inside the apartment, Elsa hears the door close and can no longer hold back. She breaks free from Andy's arms and rushes to the door, collapsing against it as sobs wrack her body.

Unknown to each other, both Dylan and Elsa cry on opposite sides of the same door.

EP 47

81 **EXT. CAMPUS - DAY** 81

Dylan walks slowly down the corridor, his usual confident stride replaced by weary steps. Principal Robertson approaches from the opposite direction.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON
(clearing his throat awkwardly)
Professor Lancaster, I need a word with you.

Dylan stops, looking up with tired eyes.

PRINCIPAL ROBERTSON (CONT'D)
The academic symposium we discussed about... we've decided to nominate Professor Chen instead. I hope you understand.

Dylan processes this for a moment, the disappointment flickering across his face before he masks it.

DYLAN
(nodding slowly)
Of course. Professor Chen is an excellent choice.

Principal Robertson nods uncomfortably and walks away.

As soon as he's gone, Veronica emerges from behind Dylan, her heels clicking ominously.

VERONICA
(voice dripping with false sweetness)
That was just a little warning, darling. If you don't start planning our wedding soon, I'll make sure your career destruction is much more... thorough.

DYLAN
(turns and looks at her)
Do whatever you want, Veronica. I honestly don't give a damn anymore.

VERONICA
(in rage)
Do you know what are you saying now?

DYLAN
Perfectly. I’m telling you, I've already lost the only thing that ever mattered to me. There's nothing left to care about.

He walks away without hesitate, leaving Veronica staring after him in fury.

Veronica's face contorts with rage as she pulls out her phone, dialing with shaking fingers.

VERONICA
(voice rising with hysteria)
I've done everything - EVERYTHING - and he still won't be mine! Fine. I'll destroy the person he cares about most!

Her voice drops to a dangerous whisper.

VERONICA (CONT'D)
Ruining that girl’s reputation isn't good enough. I want her DEAD.

EP 48

82 **EXT. UNIVERSITY GATES - DAY** 82

Dylan walks slowly toward the campus exit, his shoulders slumped with exhaustion. As he approaches the gate, he spots Elsa and Andy standing together on the sidewalk.

Elsa looks up and their eyes meet for a brief moment.

DYLAN
(calling out hopefully)
Elsa...

But she immediately turns away, as if she never heard him.

ELSA
(deliberately sweet, linking arms with Andy)
Let's go to that restaurant tonight, the one you've been wanting to try?

ANDY
(with excitement)
Really? Cool, let’s go!

Dylan watches from behind, heartbroken.

DYLAN (V.O.)
She doesn’t care anymore. I’ve lost her, forever.

ELSA
(suddenly placing her hand on her stomach)
I'm craving ice cream all of a sudden. Isn’t that weird?

ANDY
(laughing)
That's totally normal for pregnant women. Stay right here, I'll grab you some from the vendor.

Andy leaves.

Elsa's phone begins to ring. She looks down to fish it out of her purse.

Suddenly, blinding headlights flood her vision.

She looks up in terror just as a car barrels toward her.

DYLAN
(screaming from behind)
ELSA!

Dylan lunges forward desperately, but he's too far away.

The car SLAMS into Elsa with a sickening crash.

She crumples to the ground like a broken doll, her phone skittering in pieces.

Dylan reaches her collapsed form, falling to his knees beside her motionless body.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(anguished, cradling her)
No...no, no, NO! ELSA!

EP 49

83 **INT. HOSPITAL - ER - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 83

Elsa lies on the hospital bed, conscious but extremely pale and weak. Machines beep around her. A DOCTOR stands next to her bed.

DYLAN
(rushing to her side)
Elsa! How do you feel now?

ELSA
(extremely weak)
I'm...ok...

ANDY
(grabbing the doctor's arm)
Is she going to be alright?

DOCTOR
Surgery was successful, but she's not out of danger yet. Her condition could deteriorate at any moment.

The doctor pauses, choosing his words carefully.

DOCTOR (CONT'D)
If we terminate the pregnancy, we can use more aggressive medications that could improve her chances of recovering. But if we try to keep the baby, I can't promise anything...

DYLAN
(interrupting desperately)
Then no baby! Save Elsa! Nothing's more important than her life!

Elsa's hand shoots out, gripping the doctor's wrist with surprising strength.

ELSA
I want to keep my baby. You have to save my baby, doctor...

DYLAN
(leaning over her, frantic)
Elsa! This isn't the time! Your life is what matters!

ELSA
(tears streaming, voice breaking)
But...this is your...

DYLAN
(confused and horrified)
My what?

EP 50

84 **INT. HOSPITAL - ER - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 84

Elsa stares at Dylan.

ELSA (V.O.)
I wish I could tell you... But you don't want this baby. You don't want us together. You would hate me...

ELSA
...This is not your decision to make. The baby is important to me.

DYLAN
(furious)
More important than your own life?

ELSA
(breathless)
Yes! It’s my body, my choice!

The monitors suddenly start beeping frantically as Elsa's vitals spike from the emotional stress.

DOCTOR
(alarmed, calling to nurses)
Code blue! Get her to surgery now!

Medical staff swarm around Elsa's bed.

DOCTOR (CONT'D)
(pushing the men toward the door)
Both of you! Leave immediately!

As they leave, they see Elsa grabbing the doctor's hand.

ELSA
(barely audible, gasping)
Doctor... please... save my baby..

85 **INT. HOSPITAL - OUTSIDE ER - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 85

Dylan and Andy are pushed out of ER. Doors slam shut and the red light above flickers on.

Dylan suddenly whirls around and throws a vicious punch at Andy's jaw.

DYLAN
(voice raw with anguish)
It’s all your fault! You bastard!

EP 51

86 **INT. HOSPITAL - OUTSIDE ER - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 86

Andy glares at Dylan with pure hatred, wiping blood from his split lip.

ANDY
My fault?

Dylan grabs Andy by the collar, his face twisted with rage and grief.

DYLAN
(voice breaking with fury)
Damn right! You violated her, got her pregnant, and now she's willing to die for your bastard child!

Andy finally snaps. He throws a heavy punch that sends Dylan crashing to the floor, blood trickling from his mouth.

Andy towers over Dylan's fallen form.

ANDY
(voice cold with contempt)
You still don't get it, do you? You have no idea what you've done?

Dylan looks up at him, confused and dazed.

DYLAN
What?

Andy drops to his knees and grabs Dylan by the shirt.

ANDY
(shouting)
Who really hurt her? Who's the one that's really killing her?

Dylan stares at him, stunned.

Suddenly, fragmented images flash through Dylan's mind like lightning:

FLASHBACK - Dylan's bedroom, dimly lit. His face flushed with desire as he gazes at Elsa. Their lips kissing desperately, bodies intertwined on his bed, moving together in passion.

FLASHBACK - Dylan whispering against her ear:

DYLAN
I just want to love you. I just want you... to be MINE.

Dylan's face goes ghost white as the realization hits him like a freight train.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
(barely a whisper)
No...no...that can’t be...

Andy continues his assault, landing another punch.

ANDY
Who shattered her heart? Who slept with her irresponsibly and forgot about it like it meant nothing? Who left her pregnant, risking her own life to to keep the baby?

Andy kneels down and stares into Dylan's horrified eyes.

ANDY (CONT'D)
(voice deadly quiet)
It’s YOU, Professor Lancaster. You did this to her.

EP 52

87 **INT. HOSPITAL - OUTSIDE ER - NIGHT - CONTINUOUS** 87

Dylan stares back in complete shock, his world crashing down.

DYLAN
We really slept together that night...? That's... that's my child? Elsa is carrying my baby?

ANDY
(voice dripping with contempt)
What the hell did you think?! She loves you more than anything - she'd never touch another man!

DYLAN
(struggling to understand)
But why... why didn't she tell me?

ANDY
(exploding with rage)
How could she?! You've spent years pushing her away with your excuses - age, status, reputation. You care about everything except her! She was like some dirty secret to you!

Andy's voice grows more vicious.

ANDY (CONT'D)
Your father, and Veronica - they tortured her while you stood there and did nothing! Tell me, if she had told you, would you have protected her? Let alone her child?

Dylan slowly stands up from the ground, overwhelmed by guilt.

Andy grabs him roughly.

ANDY (CONT'D)
(voice breaking)
Elsa never betrayed you, not once. She couldn't bear to watch you lose your career and precious reputation she suffered in silence instead.

DYLAN
No...

ANDY
She was willing to sacrifice everything for you, endured humiliation and hatred, loved you with her very life. And what did you do for her? WHAT DID YOU DO?!

DYLAN
What...did I do...

Suddenly, alarms blare from the operating room.

Both men rush to the surgery doors as the doctor emerges, removing his surgical mask.

DYLAN & ANDY
How is she!

The doctor looks at them both with profound sadness and slowly shakes his head.

Both men freeze in horror.

EP 53

88 **INT. HOSPITAL ROOM - NIGHT** 88

Elsa's eyes flutter open. Dylan and Andy are sitting beside her bed, both looking exhausted.

ANDY
(relieved, leaning forward)
Elsa! You’re awake!

Andy helps her sit up slowly. Elsa looks around disoriented, then her hand instinctively moves to her stomach.

ELSA
(voice weak but urgent)
My baby...how is my baby!

Andy's expression darkens with sorrow.

ANDY
(voice breaking)
We couldn't save the baby. I'm so sorry, Elsa.

Elsa's eyes immediately fill with tears of devastation.

Dylan taps Andy on the shoulder. Andy looks conflicted.

ANDY (CONT'D)
(reluctantly nodding)
You two should talk.

Andy leaves the room, closing the door softly behind him.

Dylan moves to sit on the edge of Elsa's bed, gently taking her trembling hand.

DYLAN
(voice raw)
Elsa... I know everything now. The baby was mine.

Elsa's breath catches.

ELSA
(panicked whisper)
Dylan...

He reaches out, fingers tracing her face with desperate tenderness.

DYLAN
(voice breaking)
I remembered that night. Every touch, every kiss, every moment I held you...

His thumb brushes her bottom lip.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
God...What have I done to you...

ELSA
(tear falling)
It doesn’t matter now. The baby’s gone. I will leave, as you wish.
(MORE)

ELSA (CONT'D)
I won’t hurt your reputation, your career, your father’s-

Dylan silences her by pressing closer, his forehead touching hers.

DYLAN
Fuck my reputation. Fuck everything else.

His hands frame her face.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
In that operating room, watching you slip away... I realized I'd rather lose everything than lose you.

ELSA
(voice trembling)
Dylan, stop. Don’t say it unless you really mean...

DYLAN
(interrupting, husky)
I mean it. I love you. I’ve loved you for so long. It’s killing me!

Elsa grows closer, their faces inches apart.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Do you still love me, Elsa?

ELSA
(breathing unsteadily)
How could I not...You’re in my blood, Dylan.

DYLAN
(smiles)
Elsa, I’ll spend the rest of my life making it up to you.

Elsa's heart races at his proximity, his heat, his desperate confession.

EP 54

89 **EXT. CAMPUS - DAY** 89

Joe Lancaster stands at the center getting interviewed by media, beaming with political confidence. Dylan and Veronica flank him.

JOE
(voice booming with pride)
I'm thrilled to announce that my son Professor Dylan Lancaster and the wonderful Professor Veronica Fisher are officially engaged! The wedding will be held next month!

Veronica clings to Dylan's arm, flashing an enormous diamond ring at the cameras. Reporters snap photos eagerly as Dylan smiles graciously, playing his part.

JOE (CONT'D)
Thanks to this union between our families, I've received unprecedented support! Victory in the governor's race is within our grasp! Thank you all!

The crowd applauds as Joe prepares to step down from the podium.

Suddenly, Dylan moves forward and grabs the microphone.

DYLAN
(voice cutting through the applause)
Wait. I have something to say.

The crowd falls silent.

Dylan pulls out a folded document.

JOE
(alarmed)
Dylan! What are you doing?

Dylan ignores him.

DYLAN
(voice steady and clear)
This is evidence I've compiled showing how my father and Veronica Fisher's family have been bribing major corporations and manipulating votes in this election.

He holds up the papers for everyone to see.

VERONICA
(in total shock)
What?!

DYLAN
I'm releasing all of this information to the public. Now.

Chaos erupts. Reporters surge forward, cameras flash wildly, and the crowd erupts in shocked murmur.

Joe Lancaster grips on Dylan's arm.

JOE
(furious, hissing)
Have you lost your damn mind?!

Dylan turns to face both his father and Veronica, his expression cold and resolute.

DYLAN
You two destroyed my baby. Now I'm going to destroy you.

A reporter pushes forward with a microphone.

REPORTER
Professor Lancaster, your career will be ruined by this revelation. Don't you care about your future?

DYLAN
(lets out a carefree laugh)
This is my debt. It's time to pay.

Police come to get Joe and Veronica. Dylan glances one final time across the campus and walks away through the chaos.

90 **EP 55** 90

90 **EXT.** DYLAN'S HOUSE **- DAY** 90

Bright sunlight streams through the trees as a taxi pulls up to a house. Elsa slowly gets out, moving carefully due to her still-healing surgery. DRIVER helps her with her suitcases.

DRIVER
No family comes to help?

ELSA
I don't have any family left.

DRIVER
Oh...then take care, Miss.

Taxi drives away. Elsa approaches his front door and fumbles for her keys. As she opens the door, she stops in surprise.

ELSA
What is this...

Colorful balloons filled everywhere welcoming her. She follows the trail of balloons, her confusion growing.

91 **INT. DYLAN’S HOUSE - ELSA'S BEDROOM - DAY - CONTINUOUS** 91

Elsa opens her bedroom door and gasps.

At the end of the balloon trail is Dylan, holding a bouquet of roses, wearing an elegant suit. He looks like a knight from a fairy tale.

DYLAN
Princess Elsa...

Then he's kneeling on one knee, holding an open ring box that sparkles in the light.

DYLAN (CONT'D)
Will you be Uncle Dylan’s bride?

Elsa's hands fly to her mouth in complete shock and joy.

ELSA
(breathless, eyes filling with happy tears)
Dylan...

Elsa runs toward him, her voice ringing with pure happiness.

ELSA (CONT'D)
(shouting joyfully)
Yes, yes, yes, YES!

She throws herself into his arms as he stands. They embrace in the golden light, spinning together as if they're the only two people in the world.

Between the floating balloons, they kiss — no guilt, no countdown, just the two of them